

ious pieces are stored, how they are arranged, and which codecs are used by which pieces. It carries all of the information that tells the computer how to read the file. AVI, Ogg, MOV, ASF, and MP4 are all container formats.

3.1.1 How do I find a missing codec?

When a video is coded with a specific codec and it is not present or properly installed on the user's machine, the video won't play at all, or it won't play properly.

To help solve this, you can use one of these codec analysis tools:

1. VideoInspector (www.kcsoftwares.com) : Analyses most containers (AVI, Matroska, MPEG, and more) and gives download links for the missing codecs.
2. Gspot (www.headbands.com/gspot): A pioneer in troubleshooting video applications, GSpot is a very useful tool despite being lacking in some features.
3. MediaInfo (<http://mediainfo.sourceforge.net>) : An open source alternative to GSpot.
4. AVICodec (<http://avicodec.duby.info>) : A useful application, mainly for the AVI container format.
5. AVI2Clipboard (<http://wantos.mosaiegh.net>): An extension to the Explorer context menu to easily view and save information about videos within an AVI container.



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The above-mentioned software can be downloaded and run to analyse a video file. However, some caution serves well while installing any codec, since certain ones are known to be incompatibilities with some media players.